VALENTINA GONZÁLEZ-ROSTANI

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Academic Appointments

University of Southern California (USC) *Fall 2025–Present*
Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science and International Relations
Offer received in Fall 2023; start deferred to Fall 2025

Princeton University *2024–2025*
Postdoctoral Research Associate, Department of Politics.
Affiliated with the Mamdouha S. Bobst Center for Peace and Justice. PI Carles Boix.

Affiliations

OpenAI, Economic Research Exchange Fellow *2026–2027*

Mobilization & Political Economy Program, NSF REU (Renewal) *2026–2029*
Senior personal, lecturer & student mentor

Mobilization & Political Economy Program, NSF REU (Award # 2150250) *2023–2026*
Program advisor, lecturer & student mentor

National System of Researchers (SNI), ANII, Uruguay *2025–Present*

Education

Ph.D. in Political Science, University of Pittsburgh *2024*
Dissertation: Political-Economic Polarization
Mancur Olson Best Dissertation Award in Political Economy (APSA), 2026

M.A. in Political Science, University of Pittsburgh *2021*

Master in Public Policy, Universidad Católica del Uruguay *2019*

Diploma of Specialization in Methods, Universidad Católica del Uruguay *2017*

B.A. in Accounting, Universidad de la República *2015*

Publications

G: Graduate student

"Love of Variety? An Experimental Study of Heterogeneous Responses to Foreign Brands in the Marketplace" with Jude Hays. *Political Science Research and Methods*, 2026

"Can Taxing the Super-Rich Unite Workers? Billionaire Visibility and Coalitional Potential" with Santiago Lopez-Cariboni. *Latin American Politics and Society* (Conditionally Accepted)

"The Threat of Automation and Public Support for Environmental Regulation" with Liam Beiser-McGrath and Michaël Aklin. *Ecological Economics*, 2026

"Sustaining Pathway Programs in the Social Sciences" with Chie Togami, Tania Ramirez,^{G} Fernando Tormos-Aponte and Yeneca Lee.^{G} *Perspectives on Undergraduate Research & Mentoring*, 2026

"Elections, Right-wing Populism, and Political-Economic Polarization: The Role of Institutions and Political Outsiders." *The Journal of Politics*, 2026

"Creating Pathways to Graduate Success: Reducing Barriers for Underrepresented Minority Students in the Social Sciences" with Tania Ramirez,^{G} Chie Togami et al. 2026. *Teaching Sociology* (Conditionally Accepted)

"Engaging Diversity: An Inclusive Approach to Undergraduate Mentorship in Mobilization and Political Economy" with Chie Togami, Mariely Lopez-Santana, Tania Ramirez,^{G} Fernando Tormos-Aponte, and Mayra Velez-Serrano. *PS: Political Science & Politics*, 2025

"Are Protests Contagious? The Dynamics of Temporal and Spatial Diffusion of Political Protests" with Jeffrey Nonnemacher. *Journal of Elections, Public Opinion & Parties*, 2025

"Engaged Robots, and Disengaged Workers: Automation and Political Apathy." *Economics & Politics*, 2024

Recognized for being top viewed article - Wiley 2025

"Social Media vs. Surveys: A New Scalable Approach to Understanding Political Discourse" with Jose Incio and Guillermo Lezama. *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, 2024

Recognized for being top viewed article - Wiley 2025

"Moral and Economic Dimensions of Ideology" with Scott Morgenstern, Elias Chavarria, and Chen Chuang. *Legislative Studies Quarterly*, 2024

"Legislators' Religiosity and Same-Sex Marriage in Latin America" with Scott Morgenstern. *Latin America Research Review*, 2023

Book Chapters

"AI's Economy and Its Political and Institutional Consequences" with Carles Boix, Michael Becher, and Daniel Stegmueller. In Nathaniel Persily and Joshua A. Tucker (ed). Artificial Intelligence, Politics, and Political Science. Forthcoming Cambridge University Press.

"Failing Faster, Learning Better: Agentic AI and Empirical Social Science Research" with Charles Crabtree and Jae Yeon Kim. In Rohan Alexander (ed). Notes on the Future of Quantitative Social Science. Forthcoming CRC Press.

"Legislators' Religiosity and Same-Sex Marriage in Latin America" with Scott Morgenstern. In Dennis P. Petri (ed). The Routledge Handbook of Religion and Politics in Latin America. Forthcoming Abingdon/New York: Routledge.

Research

G: Graduate student

Under Review

"From Automation to "Make It Great Again": The Cultural Path to Right-Wing Populism" (R&R *Comparative Political Studies*)

"Navigating Uncertainty: How Experience Shapes Perception and Politics in the AI Era" with Tobias Tober (R&R *Political Science Research and Methods*)

"Immigration Shocks and Politicians' Rhetoric: Evidence from The Venezuelan Migration Crisis" with Jose Incio and Guillermo Lezama (R&R *Legislative Studies Quarterly*)

"Tracing AI Assistance and AI Agents in Survey Research" with Shir Raviv (Reject & Resubmit *Political Analysis*)

"Which Populism, Where? Measuring Narrative Strategy at the Sentence Level" with Bree Bang-Jensen and Michael Colaresi

"Automation from Abroad: External Technological Change and the Reorganization of Globalization"

"When Machines Manage: Workers' Demands and Trade Union Responses to AI" with Paolo Agnolin

"The Political Ramifications of AI-Augmented Work" with Shir Raviv

"Who Influences Whom? Analyzing the Interplay of Mainstream and Outsider Parties in Social Media Campaigns" with Claudia Salas Gimenez^G

Working Papers

"The Political Economy of Automation and Fragmented Production in a Global Economy: Evidence from Mexico" with Carles Boix and Erica Owen

"Estimating Spatially Structured Cross-Level Effects in Multilevel Models Using INLA" with Jude Hays

"Automation narrows migration as an adjustment channel in the Mexico–U.S. corridor"

Selected Works in Progress

"The Political Economy of AI Infraestructure"

"Collective Agreements in the Age of Artificial Intelligence" with Paolo Agnolin

"AI, Capital Concentration, and the Fate of Competition: Natural Monopolies, Antitrust, and the Politics of Big Tech Power" with Carles Boix

"The Untouchables: Why We Don't Demand Taxes on Big Tech?" with Santiago Lopez-Cariboni

"When Money Talks: Rethinking Income Redistribution and Political Inequality" with Jude Hays

"Survey-grounded synthetic agents from high-dimensional opinion data" with Guillermo Lezama

"A Networked Approach to Addressing Underrepresentation in the Social and Behavioral Sciences" with Fernando Tormos-Aponte, Chie Togami, Tania Ramirez,^{G} Mayra Velez-Serrano, Mariely Lopez-Santana, and Yeneca Lee.^{G}

Software

`tscsdep`: Tools for analyzing country-year time-series-cross-sectional data with spatial and temporal dependence. Available on GitHub Github/STADL with Jude Hays, Scott Cook, and Robert Franzese.

Selected Awards & Research Grants

Schmidt Sciences, $199,879 *2027-2029*
AI at Work: Impact of AI on Worker Displacement and Adjustment
OpenAI Economic Research Exchange $115,000 2026-2027
Includes a one-year data partnership supported by a paid in-house team member.
Mancur Olson Best Dissertation Award in Political Economy (APSA) 2026
Schmidt Sciences, *AI at Work* $10,000 *2026*
Russell Sage Foundation, *Future of Work*
[Invited to submit & R&R, Under review], $200,000 *2026*
Russell Sage Foundation, *Behavioral Science and Decision Making in Context*
[Invited to submit & R&R, Under review], $200,000 *2025*
Center for International Studies RA Support, $42,436 *2026–2027*
USC Sherwin Family Research Support Fund (w/Salas^{G}) $12,000 *2026*
USC - POIR Research Award, $9,999 *2026*
USC - POIR Travel Award, $2,000 *2025*
Center for International Studies Research Award, $10,000 *2025–2026*
Princeton University, Data Driven Social Science (w/ Agnolin) $7,000 *2025–2026*
Center for International Studies RA Support, $41,200 *2025–2026*
Princeton University, Research Award $10,000 *2024–2025*
USC - POIR Research Award, $50,000 *2023*
Andrew W. Mellon Predoctoral Fellow, $\sim$ $ 25,000 *2023–2024*
Rosenbluth Junior Scholar Award in Political Economy (APSA) 2023
National Science Foundation
PolMeth *2023, 2025*
Mobilization and Political Economy, Summer Research Program *2023*
EITM Summer School *2022*
Georgia Tech's Center for European Studies — J. Monnet, Erasmus+ *2023*
American Political Science Association
APSA Travel Grants *2023*
Formal Theory Section Grant *2022*
University of Pittsburgh
European Studies Center Grant *2022–2023*
Social Sciences Doctoral Dissertation (SSDD) *2022–2023*
Arts & Sciences Summer Fellowships *2021, 2022, 2023*

Talks & Guest Lectures

U: Upcoming C: Invited but unable to attend due to visa issues

Invited Talks & Workshops

2027

USCD, Methods Speaker Series^{U} · Global Research in International Political Economy workshop (GRIPE)^{U}

2026

UC Santa Barbara, CPEIR seminar^{U} · OpenAI Economic Research Exchange, The Economics of AI · IDB 64th Meeting of the Network of Central Banks and Finance Ministries (Session on the Economic Implications of Artificial Intelligence)^{U} · Washington University in St.Louis, The Political Economy of Technological Change^{U} · USC, Department of Sociology Colloquium^{U} · Northeastern University, AI & Politics^{U} · Pontifical Catholic University of Peru^{U} · Schmidt Sciences AI at Work · Yale University, AI for Social Science Research Methods · Bocconi University, AI and Society · University of Toronto, Applications of AI · University of Zurich, A New Politics of Artificial Intelligence? · University of Pittsburgh, Speaker series - NSF REU-Mobilization & Political Economy · Texas A&M University, Globalization Backlash · University of California, Riverside, Political Science Speaker Series· University of Washington, Severyns-Ravenholt Seminar · USC Center for International Studies, IR Seminar · USC Sol Price School of Public Policy, Political Institutions & Political Economy Seminar · APSA Labor Politics Group workshop

2025

Columbia University · IDB, Digital Technologies—Growth & Well-Being in Emerging Economies · Monash–Paris–Warwick–Zurich–CEPR, 10th Text-As-Data Workshop · MPE-NSF REU · NYU, Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics · Nuffield College, Oxford^{C} · Penn State–Pitt IR Annual Workshop · Special Issue Workshop "The Future of Labor" · IBEI, Barcelona^{C} · University of Nebraska–Lincoln, Hendricks Symposium · UNESCO^{C} · University of Pennsylvania, Junior Scholars in IR · Universidad de la Republica · Yale University–ISPS

2024

Caltech CSSPP · Princeton University–Niehaus Center, IR Faculty Colloquium · Princeton University, Political Economy Colloquium · Yale University–MacMillan Center

2023

APSA Political Economy, Rosenbluth Junior Scholar Workshop · Boston University · Birmingham University · CIDE · Georgia Tech · GSIPE Workshop · MPE-NSF REU · UC Berkeley (ACES) · Universidad Católica del Uruguay · Universidad de Salamanca · University of Southern California · University of Strathclyde · University of Pittsburgh, Comparative Politics Seminar · Penn State–Pitt IR Annual Workshop · University of Zürich

2022

EITM Institute · Techno-Debate

2021

Universidad Católica del Uruguay · University of Pittsburgh

Conferences

APPAM (2025) · APSA (2022^{C}, 2023, 2024, 2026^{U}) · Environmental Politics & Governance (2022) · EPSA (2023) · EUSA (2022, 2023) · IPES (2022, 2024, 2025) · ISA (2025) · LACEA-LAMES (2024) · LASA (2021, 2023) · LAPolMeth (2024, 2025^{C}) · MPSA (2021–2025) · NABE Tech Economics Conference (2025) · SoCalMeth (2026^{U}) · PolMeth (2023, 2025, 2026) ·

Teaching & Mentoring

U: Undergraduate G: Graduate

University of Southern California

Advanced Methodology: Text as Data^{G}	2025, 2027
Introduction to Data Analysis^{U}	2026
The Politics of International Trade^{U}	2026, 2027

Students — Committee Member / Mentor

Valeria Flores-Cadena^{G} (USC) 2026–Present
Karen Borglund^{U} (USC) 2026-Present
Brady Allardice (Universitat Pompeu Fabra, USC visiting student) 2026
Hugo Lopez Plascencia^{U} (UCR, MPE NSF-REU) 2026
Linton Lee^{G} (USC) 2026–Present
Claudia Salas Gimenez^{G} (USC) 2025–Present
Yana Demeshko^{G} (USC) 2025–2026
Paula Martinez^{G} (Udelar, Uruguay) 2025

Pre-PhD Teaching & Mentoring

Mobilization and Political Economy, NSF REU^{U}
Instructor and Mentor Summer 2023
Placed students from underrepresented backgrounds in grad programs.
Supervised 4 undergraduate research projects and Ph.D. applications.

University of Pittsburgh
Research Methods in Political Science^{U}
Instructor of Record Summer 2022
Teaching Assistant Fall 2021 & Spring 2022
Undergraduate and Graduate Student Mentoring 2022–2024
Supervised 4 undergraduate research assistants; mentored 6 first-year Ph.D. students.

Universidad de la República (Uruguay)
Teaching Assistantships^{U} 2014–2019
Labor Law and Social Security; Accounting I–III; Administration of Organizations; Housing Cooperatives Training.
Mentored 60+ first-generation undergraduate students 2013–2016

Training in Pedagogy
Achievement in Pedagogy Badge, University of Pittsburgh 2021–2022
Faculty Development Practicum, University of Pittsburgh Fall 2021
Faculty Development Course, Universidad de la República Spring 2016

Methods & Political Economy Training

Gen AI Intensive Course with Google 2025
Prompt engineering, embeddings, and generative AI agents.

APSA Dissertation Workshop 2023
New Topics in European Politics, Kleine (LSE) & Obholzer (Leiden University).

EITM Institute, UC Berkeley — NSF-sponsored Summer School 2022

Winter School in Methods, Universidad Católica del Uruguay 2016–2018
Bargaining using formal models, N. Bapat (UNC Chapel Hill)
Methods for interpretation and analysis of RDD, S. Calonico (U of Miami)
Case studies using process tracing, C. Rosell (UCU)

IPSA-USP Summer School, Brazil 2018
Field research in PolSci, Melani Cammett (Harvard University)
Advanced issues in quantitative methods, Bruno Cautres (Sciences Po)

Reviewer

American Journal of Political Science · *Business and Politics* · *British Journal of Political Science* ($\times 2$) · *Comparative Politics* · *European Political Science Review* · *Government and Opposition* · *International Interactions* ($\times 2$) · *International Organization* ($\times 2$) · *The Journal of Politics* ($\times 3$) · *Legislative Studies Quarterly* · *Review of International Organizations* · *Review of International Political Economy*

Selected Service

Political Science
Volunteer mentor, program for first-gen and minority students 2026
Member, APSA Task Force on AI and Political Science 2025–Present

Discussant PolMeth (×2)	2026
Discussant APSA	2026
Discussant WashU, Political Economy of Tech Change	2026
Chair, APPAM, AI panel	2025
Grad Students in International Political Economy (GSIPE) team	2023–2024
Chair & discussant, EPSA, Political Economy of Labor panel	2023
Discussant, "Rethink Populism and Technocracy" Workshop, University of Pittsburgh	2022
Chair, LASA	2021

University of Southern California

Faculty Representative for Methods, Ph.D. Admissions & Steering Committee	2026-2028
Convener, CIS International Relations Workshop series	2026-2027
Speaker at Workshop CIS, Research and Methods in the AI era	2026
Faculty Participant, Predoctoral Institute for First-Generation Scholars	2026

University of Pittsburgh

Search Committee, Associate Professor — Structural Racism	2022–2023
Search Committee, Assistant Professor — Structural Racism	2022–2023
Search Committee, Postdoc with DEI focus	2022
Grad student rep, Diversity, Equity & Inclusion PolSci Committee	2020–2022
President of PolSci Graduate Students	2021–2022
Representative of PolSci at the GSO	2021–2022

Universidad de la República

TA representative at University government	2019
Undergraduate student representative at University government	2013–2015
Member of advisory committees (e.g., study plan design)	2013–2015

Broad Audience

Co-director, *Razones y Personas* social science diffusion blog	2024–Present
Speaker, WS × Columbia University GD Fireside Talk Series	2025
Speaker, IUSY series on the future of work	2023

Relevant Skills

Computational: Stata, R, Python **Survey:** Qualtrics **Text Annotation:** Inception
NLP: spaCy, Hugging Face Transformers, PyTorch, NLTK, Codex
Language: Spanish (native speaker)

Other Work Experience

Academic Advisor to the Dean, FCEA Udelar	*2017–2019*
Advisor, National Congressman — economic, labor, and budget issues	*2015–2017*
KPMG, Tax Analyst	*2015–2016*
Political & Union Organizer	*2011–2019*

References

Carles Boix
Robert Garrett Professor of Politics and Public Affairs, Princeton University
cboix@princeton.edu

Erica Owen
Associate Professor, University of Pittsburgh
ericaowen@pitt.edu

Michaël Aklin
Chair of Policy & Sustainability Lab
Associate Professor, EPFL
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jch61@pitt.edu

Michael Colaresi
William S. Dietrich II Chair of Political Science & Associate Vice Provost for Data Science, University of Pittsburgh
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